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Product Design Engineer

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Product design engineer with 20+ years helping teams take products from an unclear problem to a shipped, accessible product. Most of my titles say engineer because that's the seat teams hired me into. In most of those roles the job also meant learning what users actually need and deciding how the product should behave, alongside product, design, and engineering. On a design system team, I use the same skills to support designers, so the components they design reach roughly 3,500 engineers and designers as intended.

HOW I WORK

Research the problem
Use interviews, audits, analytics, and experiments to decide what's worth building, then cut scope to the useful path.

Design it with the team
Prototype and validate with product, design, and engineering in the team's codebase, so decisions get tested in working software.

Make it work for everyone
Accessibility, performance, translated content, and errors people can recover from, treated as part of the product rather than a final pass.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer II, Design System · Travelers

2025 - PRESENT

- Support the design team by automating Figma Code Connect mapping, so designers and engineers no longer translate the same components by hand.
- Gave roughly 3,500 engineers and designers across the organization one accessible component set to build against, cutting duplicate UI work.
- Cut more than 10 hours of setup per component story by automating Storybook story generation, returning that time to feature work.
- Raised adoption by documenting accessibility expectations, implementation guidance, and cross-framework usage, so consuming teams ship correct patterns without asking.

Freelance UI Designer/Developer · Independent

2010 - 2025

- Rebuilt VMSpark's admin app on a design system made for its operators after a heuristic audit scored it 3.5 out of 10; a re-score with the same rubric reached 7.5, and every delete now asks for confirmation.
- Gave five parties one shipment record at IVFCRYO after interviews showed the hard part was getting everyone ready before a shipment could start, cutting support calls 75% and shipping errors 55%.
- Deliver full-stack prototypes and production applications for clients when building is faster than specifying.

Senior UX/UI Developer · Logatot, Inc.

2023 - 2024

- Moved documentation from evening paperwork to hands-free voice capture after interviews showed providers were filling in records from memory at night; numerous providers reported saving more than two hours daily.
- Matched speech against a known list, using AI only to predict likely mishearings when a child is added, because a compliance record can't afford a confident guess.
- Turned compliance into a by-product of daily work: attendance records, signed releases, CACFP claims, and drill logs all generate from events providers log during the day.
- Shipped to market as a paid product in English and Spanish, sold direct and through child care associations.

Senior Software Engineer (UI) · America's Test Kitchen 2022 - 2023

- Moved consumer-facing experiences off a legacy Rails platform onto one documented React and Next.js component library that serves multiple editorial brands without separate implementations.
- Kept behavior in components and brand differences in tokens, so every brand gets the same keyboard and focus handling.
- Settled design questions with Optimizely A/B tests and the site's analytics stack.
- Protected performance, accessibility, and security by weighing every third-party script against what it cost the page.
- Returned to formalize the company's first accessibility team and mission, closing the gap to WCAG 2.2 on every platform.

Principal Design Engineer · Berkshire Hathaway Specialty Insurance 2018 - 2022

- Gave Berxi, the company's direct-to-consumer insurance platform, a design system with two-tier tokens, so marketing could launch campaigns and landing pages without waiting on engineering for visual changes, and brand updates reached every component automatically.
- Focused the roadmap on the screens underwriters and agents used most, based on Segment and Heap data from the portals.
- Made underwriting, administration, customer service, and agent workflows usable at scale through data-heavy tables, filters, forms, and dashboards.
- Standardized front-end work across internal, agent, and customer portals with one shared UI library, so teams stopped rebuilding the same patterns.

Lead UI Developer · America's Test Kitchen 2016 - 2018

- Sped up development while improving consistency, accessibility, SEO, and performance across digital properties with a scalable UI utility system.
- Raised the team's baseline by training engineers on accessible markup, performance, and durable UI practices.
- Earned the Breaking Bread Award for strengthening the brand's digital engagement.

SELECTED TOOLKIT

DESIGN & CRAFT	Accessible UI, Adobe CS, Design-to-code, Figma, Heuristic evaluation, Journey mapping, Prototyping, Responsive design, User interviews, WCAG 2.1 / 2.2, Workflow design.
DATA & EXPERIMENTATION	Core Web Vitals, Google Analytics, Heap, Hotjar, HubSpot, Optimizely, Segment.
FRONT END	Alpine.js, Astro, CSS, Gatsby, HTML, HTMX, Hotwire, JavaScript, React, Sass, Stencil Web Components, Stimulus, Storybook, Tailwind, TypeScript, Vue.
SYSTEMS & TESTING	CI workflows, Component libraries, Cypress, Design systems, Design tokens, Figma Code Connect, Git, Jest, Lighthouse, Node scripts, Playwright, Vitest.
BACK END & HOSTING	Heroku, Netlify, Next, Nuxt, Ruby on Rails.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Biology, minor in Chemistry · Troy University

Continuing education · Senior UX/UI/Product Designer + AI curriculum (Interaction Design Foundation (IxDF)), Web Accessibility (Deque University)

Certifications in progress · IAAP CPACC and WAS accessibility exams